

Comparing U.S. News Topic Trends and Public Interest on Yahoo News and Reuters

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Three Web Sources:

1. Source 1: Yahoo News U.S.

URL: <https://news.yahoo.com/us/>

Method: Web scraping using BeautifulSoup

Use: Source 1 provides the main article-level data from Yahoo News U.S. such as titles, summaries, time information and links. These data will be used to identify the topics that appear frequently on Yahoo News.

2. Source 2: Reuters United States

URL: <https://www.reuters.com/world/us/>

Method: Web scraping using BeautifulSoup

Use: Source 2 is used to compare differences between platforms. It helps examine whether similar news topic is presented in the same way across Yahoo News and Reuters. This source will provide article-level data from Reuters U.S., such as titles, summaries, time information and links.

3. Source 3: Google Trends

URLs:

<https://trends.google.com/trends/>

<https://trends.google.com/explore>

Method: downloading trend data (CSV) based on keywords extracted from the news sources.

Use: This source will reflect the overall level of public attention through external reference data. For some hot news topics from Yahoo News and Reuters, it can help show whether they became popular because the platform highlighted them, or because the public was already paying attention to those topics.

Description of how the sources combine:

This project compares the U.S. news content displayed on Yahoo News and Reuters by collecting article-level information from their U.S. pages during the fixed time period from April 4 to April 11, 2026. Source 1 and Source 2 are used to build a news dataset, including titles, summaries, time information, and links. After collecting and cleaning data from the two platforms, the project will identify frequently appearing topics on each platform and compare the differences between them. Because topic wording may differ across sources (for example, "US" vs. "United States"), raw topic labels will not be directly compared across Yahoo News, Reuters, and Google Trends. Instead, topic labels and keywords will be cleaned, normalized, and mapped into a common topic representation before cross-source comparison.

Google Trends will then be used as an external data source to assess whether the topics highlighted by Yahoo News and Reuters also align with broader public interest by using search trend data.

Research Question:

1. What types of topics appear more frequently on the U.S. pages of Yahoo News and Reuters?
2. Which topics appear more often on Yahoo News, and which topics appear more often on Reuters?
3. Do the topics emphasized by these platforms align with the broader public interest trends indicated by Google Trends?
4. Which topics are uniquely emphasized by only platform?